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LIT

Robinhood has spent eight months wiring a complete perps funnel around a single venue — Lighter.

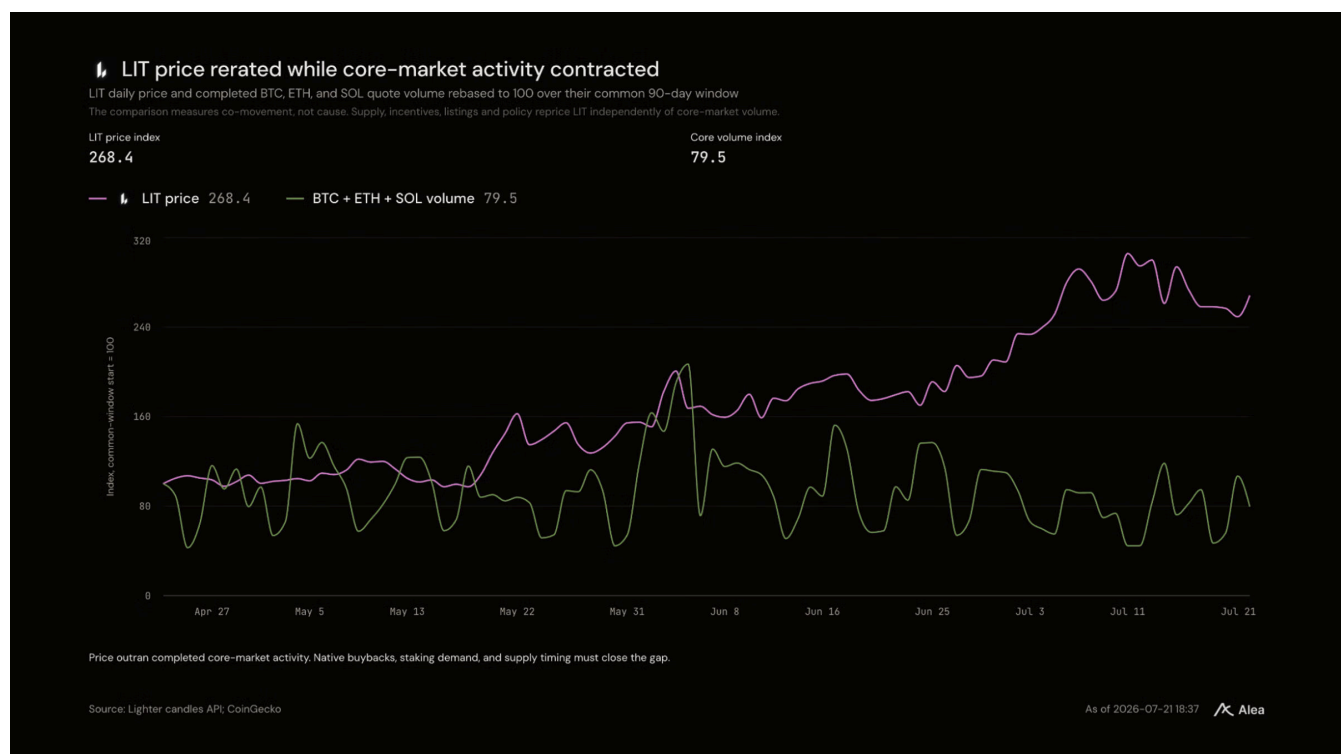
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Robinhood has spent eight months wiring a complete perps funnel around a single venue — [Lighter](#). Robinhood participated in [Lighter's November 2025 Series B](#) at a ~\$1.5B valuation, offered a [50/50 split on Wallet perp revenue](#), Vlad Tenev serves as their advisor, and [Lighter](#) is the core perp DEX [built into](#) Robinhood Wallet. This funnel is ultimately built for the [27.7M](#) funded U.S. accounts holding [\\$377B](#) on the Robinhood platform. The trade is owning the distribution pipe before the regulatory unlock reprices it, not after.

LIT bottomed near \$0.80 in April under airdrop selling and the volume decline that followed the end of points farming, and has since recovered roughly 170% into the Robinhood integration.



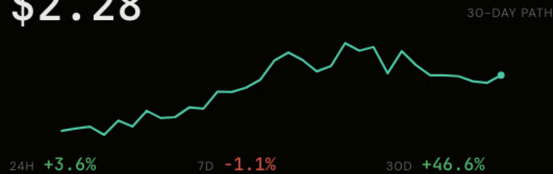
At ~\$540M market cap, LIT is 25x smaller than HYPE. LIT trades at 0.017x its 30-day volume against HYPE's 0.079x, which is ~4.5x cheaper per unit of volume than the category leader.

LIT: 22.6× circulating P/S expands to 90.3× on FDV

Lighter · price, 30-day economics, peer valuation and trading activity

SPOT PRICE

\$2.28



Current stock metrics · USD

as of Jul 21, 2026

MARKET CAP
\$570.1M

CoinGecko

FDV
\$2.28B

CoinGecko

TVL
\$523.2M

DefiLlama

CIRCULATING / FDV
25.0%

Alea derived

Operating economics

30d · Jul 20, 2026

FEES · 30D
\$2.71M

DefiLlama

PROTOCOL REVENUE
· 30D
\$2.08M

DefiLlama

HOLDER REVENUE
· 30D
\$2.02M

DefiLlama

Valuation matrix

Lower is cheaper

P/F

CIRCULATING
17.3×

FDV
69.2×

P/S

22.6×

90.3×

Perpetual venue peer context

Protocol revenue · 30d · through Jul 20, 2026

Median \$643.3K · target +223% · 75th percentile

PROTOCOL	REVENUE 30D	CIRC P/S	FDV P/S	VOLUME 30D
Lighter TARGET	\$2.08M	22.6×	90.3×	\$36.6B
Hyperliquid	\$41.3M	26.9×	115×	\$193.9B
dYdX	\$226.3K	37.2×	42.0×	\$2.22B
GMX	\$643.3K	8.6×	8.6×	\$2.69B

Valuation uses CoinGecko valuation + one provider's trailing-30d denominator × 365/30. Peer statistics exclude Lighter.

Source: CoinGecko, DefiLlama; Alea calculations · As of Jul 21, 2026

Trading and balance-sheet signals

Venue activity and capital structure.

PERP VOLUME · 30D

\$36.6B

DefiLlama

OPEN INTEREST

\$951.1M

DefiLlama

MCAP / TVL

1.1×

Alea derived

FDV / TVL

4.4×

Alea derived

Alea

On ~\$40B of 30-day volume, Lighter ranks as the 3rd largest perp venue with ~7% of DEX perp flow.

Lighter sits in the leading perpetual-venue volume cohort

Top venues ranked by trailing 30-day perpetual notional

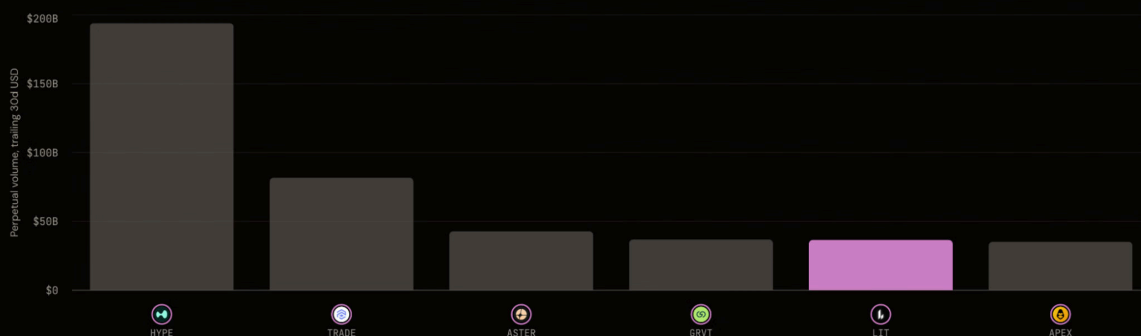
Volume measures activity, not revenue quality. Open interest, fees, holder routing, incentives, and capital efficiency remain separate tests.

Lighter rank
5

Lighter volume, 30d
\$36.55B

Cohort leader

Hyperliquid Perps



Hyperliquid Perps
\$193.87B

tradeXYZ
\$81.68B

Aster Perps
\$42.81B

Grvt Perps
\$36.85B

Lighter Perps
\$36.55B

Apex Omni
\$35.15B

Source: DefiLlama derivatives overview

As of 2026-07-21 18:40 Alea

Behind Lighter's zero-fee structure lies a system that **mirrors Robinhood's payment-for-order-flow (PFOF) model**. Robinhood offers commission-free trading by selling retail order flow to market makers, who pay for the privilege of executing against less-informed retail traders. The controversy has always been the embedded conflict of interest stemming from Robinhood optimizing routing for the highest profit rather than for a user's execution quality.

 Staked LIT buys faster execution and lower trading fees		
Standard accounts trade at 300ms with zero maker and taker fees. Premium accounts trade at 200ms to 140ms, and fees fall as effective LIT stake rises.		
SEC execution framework	Lighter account	Lighter account
Retail PFOF	Standard	Premium
Compensation for routing	0 maker / 0 taker	Stake-dependent fees
1 Broker may receive payment from a venue or market maker	1 Current taker latency: 300ms	1 Taker latency tiers: 200ms to 140ms
2 Best-execution duty remains	2 No stake requirement	2 Fee discounts increase with effective staked LIT
3 Order-routing conflict requires disclosure	3 Protocol architecture is independently documented	3 LIT stake sets fees and execution speed
Historical routing model	Verified current schedule	Verified current schedule
Investment read The fee schedule links LIT demand to faster execution and lower trading costs. Zero-knowledge verification improves auditability. Execution quality still rests on realized fills, depth and uptime.		
Source: Alea, SEC Trade Execution guide, Lighter trading-fee documentation · Zero-knowledge proofs verify protocol state. Realized execution quality depends on fills, depth and system availability		
		As of 2026-07-21 

Lighter shares the same economic logic, but its ZK matching engine eliminates the exploitation mechanism. Instead of selling the right to internalize retail flow at the trader's expense, Lighter monetizes through latency tier access, which market makers pay for competitively and which carries no directional information advantage over retail. Lighter has recreated the business model that built Robinhood without the compromise that has followed Robinhood through a decade of regulatory scrutiny.

LIT stake buys lower fees, faster execution, and more throughput

Official Premium Account economics across the full effective-stake schedule

Lighter states that trading fee revenue funds LIT buybacks. Current staking rewards also include company funds and pre-TGE revenue, so they should not be read as a pure operating yield.

LIT price
\$2.28

Market cap
\$570.92M

FDV
\$2.28B

Circulating supply
25.0%

PREMIUM ENTRY

0.0% discount

200 ms taker latency · 4K tx/min

100K LIT STAKE

20.0% discount

160 ms taker latency · 12K tx/min

500K LIT STAKE

30.0% discount

140 ms taker latency · 40K tx/min

Staked LIT	Discount	Maker fee	Taker fee	Taker latency	Tx/min
0	0.0%	0.4 bps	2.8 bps	200 ms	4K
1K	2.5%	0.39 bps	2.73 bps	195 ms	5K
3K	5.0%	0.38 bps	2.66 bps	190 ms	6K
10K	10.0%	0.36 bps	2.52 bps	180 ms	7K
30K	15.0%	0.34 bps	2.38 bps	170 ms	8K
100K	20.0%	0.32 bps	2.24 bps	160 ms	12K
300K	25.0%	0.3 bps	2.1 bps	150 ms	24K
500K	30.0%	0.28 bps	1.96 bps	140 ms	40K

The schedule creates paid demand for LIT through execution speed, fee savings, throughput, LLP access, and fee-funded buybacks. Funding rebates ended on May 15, 2026 and are excluded from current utility.

Source: Lighter LIT utility, trading fee, fee credit, historical funding rebate, and rate limit documentation; CoinGecko; DefiLlama

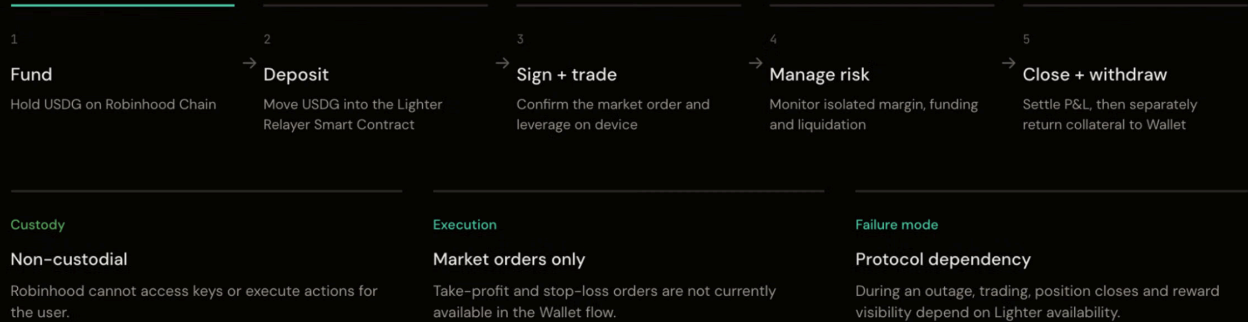
As of 2026-07-21 17:34 

What that model buys is the price point, and the price point is the user acquisition strategy. Zero fees matter to Robinhood's large retail user base because commission-free trading is the single biggest reason Robinhood [onboarded a generation of first-time investors in 2021](#). Robinhood's removal of a standard equity trade cost of \$5-\$10 per transaction created [27.7M funded accounts](#) today, with total platform assets reaching [\\$377B](#), a 47% year-on-year increase.

The average Robinhood user is [35](#), with roughly [75% of that being millennial or Gen Z](#), a cohort that expresses its speculative instincts through mobile-first interfaces and event-driven trades. These are the users who chased GameStop in January 2021, generating [3.2M app downloads](#) in a single month, and they will chase the next crypto catalyst through a leveraged perpetual position if the friction to do so is low enough.

Lighter positions in Robinhood Wallet still require five onchain steps

The Wallet keeps the trade flow in one interface. Users fund with USDG, sign on device, manage isolated margin and withdraw collateral separately.



Source: Alea, Robinhood Wallet perpetual-futures support · The current Wallet flow uses USDG, explicit device signing, isolated margin and market orders · As of 2026-07-21 Alea

That friction, at present, remains the primary barrier to migration. The same fear of managing crypto wallets, bridging assets across blockchains, and navigating smart contract interactions that held back retail adoption of dApps last cycle remains an unsolved issue this cycle. The Robinhood user most likely to migrate already trades crypto on a familiar interface and needs one credible, frictionless step onchain. This is precisely who a Robinhood-backed, zero-fee and [Apple/Google Pay-compatible](#) perp DEX is built for. Hyperliquid already won the crypto-native trader. Nobody has yet won brokerage-app retail, and Lighter is the only venue with an integrated route to it.

The catalysts ahead are aimed at regulatory clarity. In late May, the [CFTC issued](#) a policy statement that perps qualify as futures and [approved](#) Kalshi's BTC perp. [Kraken](#) followed suit, offering perps to U.S. clients in June. Lighter is also pursuing a [CFTC license](#) while founder Vlad Novakovski announced he [joined](#) the CFTC's Innovation Advisory Committee. A license would connect the venue to the 27.7M U.S. customers Robinhood already controls, the one cohort the entire funnel was built for and cannot yet touch.

The nearer catalysts are measurable weekly. Robinhood-originated deposits on Lighter stand at [\\$20M](#) now, 3 weeks after mainnet, with the [90-day fee subsidy](#) on Robinhood Chain expiring on September 29. Inflows post-subsidy should be tracked to determine whether the chain continues to onboard users without fee discounts. The hard boundary is December 30, when the [team and investor cliff](#) passes and half the supply begins vesting. This trade sits within a 5-month window in which the float is fixed and the re-rate has to arrive before the supply unlocks.